The faceless journalist stared with abject…pity.

Will it, though?

80.

PEOPLE OFTEN SPECULATED THAT I was clinging to my bachelor life because it was so glamorous. Many evenings I'd think: If only they could see me now.

Then I'd go back to folding my underwear and watching "The One with Monica and Chandler's Wedding."

Besides my own laundry (often laid out to dry on my radiators) I did my own chores, my own cooking, my own food shopping. There was a supermarket by the Palace and I went there, casually, at least once a week.

Of course I'd plan each trip as carefully as a patrol around Musa Qala. I'd arrive at different times, randomly, to throw off the press. I'd wear a disguise: low baseball cap, loose coat. I'd run along the aisles at warp speed, grabbing the salmon fillets I liked, the brand of yogurt I liked. (I'd memorized a map of the store.) Plus a few Granny Smith apples and bananas. And, of course, some crisps.

Then I'd sprint to the checkout.

Just as I'd honed my preflight checks in the Apache, I now honed my grocery shopping time down to ten minutes. But one night I got to the shop and began to run up and down the aisles and everything…had *moved*.

I hurried over to an employee: *What's happened?*

Excuse me?

Where is everything?

Where is—?

Why has everything moved?

Honestly?

Yes, honestly.